

ExamShield - Examination Integrity & Centre Operations Analytics

Research Report | NEET-UG 2026 with SSC Selection Post 2025 as an operations-risk comparison

Portfolio positioning: Independent Business Analyst case study. The project uses public evidence for documented events and a separately labelled synthetic dataset to demonstrate centre-level BI analysis.

1. Executive Summary

Examination integrity is a business-process problem as much as a security problem. Large public examinations coordinate confidential material, transport, examination centres, candidate identity, staffing, surveillance, incident handling and recovery. The public record for 2026 shows a highly layered security design around NEET-UG 2026, followed by an investigation into alleged malpractice and a later re-examination/follow-up trail. Separately, reporting around SSC Selection Post Phase XIII shows how operational disruptions can create candidate impact and data-governance challenges.

Core BA question: Where are the operational and control weaknesses, how can an examination authority prioritize exceptions, and what should a future-state control tower monitor?

2. Why the topic is current

NTA stated before NEET-UG 2026 that the exam covered 22.79 lakh registered candidates across 5,432+ centres, with 6,000+ observers and 2 lakh+ personnel. Its published security framework included sealed protocols, GPS-tracked transport, CCTV linked to centralized control rooms, frisking, biometric authentication and real-time monitoring.

The same NTA release later stated that it received inputs on 7-May-2026 regarding alleged malpractice and escalated them to central agencies on 8-May-2026; NTA said the matter was under investigation. CBI then registered a case on 12-May-2026 concerning alleged unauthorized circulation of NEET-UG 2026 examination material. Official releases on 14-27 May documented further arrests and searches, including Pune-linked activity.

The SSC comparison adds an operational data angle. Reporting on the 2025 Selection Post Phase XIII exam described cancellations, server crashes, unresponsive systems and centre changes. A September 2026 Indian Express report on an RTI/CIC exchange said SSC did not have specific data in the relevant section for candidates affected by centre changes, cancellations and technical/logistical failures, while 76,153 affected candidates underwent re-examination.

3. Research scope and boundary

In scope: public examination integrity, centre operations, incident management, candidate-impact measurement, control design, data governance and future-state analytics.

Out of scope: proving guilt, estimating the probability that a specific centre will leak papers, identifying private individuals beyond what official public releases state, or claiming that Pune centres as a whole are riskier than other locations.

Important evidence rule: allegation, arrest, reported disruption and laboratory/technical finding are different evidence states. The dataset keeps them separate.

4. Evidence timeline

Date	Event	What the source supports
2024-06-21	Act enforced	Public Examinations Act took effect
2026-05-02	22.79 lakh candidates	551 Indian cities + 14 abroad; 6000+ observers; 2 lakh+ personnel
2026-05-10	Inputs received	NTA said inputs were received on 7-May and escalated on 8-May; inquiry ongoing

Date	Event	What the source supports
2026-05-12	CBI case registered	Case concerning alleged unauthorized circulation of examination documents
2026-05-14	Arrests announced	One of the two announced arrests was from Pune
2026-05-15	Alleged access point identified	PIB reported an alleged source with access to papers and activity connected to Pune
2026-05-16	Biology question chain alleged	PIB reported another Pune-linked arrest; investigation ongoing
2026-05-18	10 arrests reported	CBI searches and investigation continued
2026-05-27	13 arrests; 49 searches	Official release said Chemistry, Biology and Physics chains were being investigated
2025-07-24	Exam disruptions reported	Cancellations, server crashes, unresponsive systems and centre changes were reported
2026-09-22	Specific impact data gap reported	SSC told CIC specific affected-candidate data was not available in relevant section
2026-06-21	Re-examination / follow-up	NTA published re-examination notices, venue changes and biometric exception guidance
2026-07-30	Amendment Bill passed Rajya Sabha	Official release said 35 of 46 high-level expert committee recommendations had been implemented
2026-07-27	Amendment Bill introduced	Proposed faster investigation/trial and stronger penalties

5. What the evidence tells us

Finding 1 - The process is already multi-layered. NTA's published NEET-UG 2026 controls span physical custody, transportation, surveillance, candidate identity and real-time monitoring. NTA's procurement page also shows dedicated requirements around biometric, CCTV, frisking/crowd management and security/surveillance services.

Finding 2 - Risk can emerge across the process, not only at the paper itself. The 2026 record includes investigation activity, candidate re-examination/follow-up notices and a separate operational-data issue in SSC. That suggests a BA opportunity around process visibility, exception handling and recovery.

Finding 3 - Pune is a case lens, not a prevalence estimate. Official 2026 CBI/PIB releases explicitly connect multiple investigative developments to Pune. This establishes Pune as part of the documented case chain, but it does not establish that a particular examination centre or all Pune centres were compromised.

Finding 4 - Data governance is itself a control objective. The SSC RTI/CIC reporting indicates that specific candidate-impact data was not available in the relevant section. A control system therefore needs not just prevention data, but also complete exception, impact and recovery records.

6. Current-state process model

Planning -> centre allocation -> material preparation -> secure movement -> receipt at centre -> identity verification -> exam conduct -> incident capture -> escalation -> investigation/recovery -> result/re-examination -> audit closure

The weak point from a BA perspective is not necessarily a missing control; it is the possibility that evidence from multiple control layers is not consolidated into one decision view.

7. Business questions for the BI report

- How many public evidence events occurred by year and event category?
- Which documented events have an explicit Pune link?
- Which control layers are described in official exam-security materials?
- What operational-risk indicators should a centre dashboard monitor?
- How quickly are incidents resolved, and how much candidate impact results?
- Where does public data remain incomplete or non-comparable?

8. Data strategy

The portfolio intentionally uses a two-layer data model. **Layer A - Public Evidence Register** contains only source-backed events and metrics extracted from official or clearly identified secondary sources. **Layer B - Illustrative Centre Operations** contains 240 synthetic centre-day records created only to demonstrate SQL, KPI logic, risk scoring and dashboard design. Synthetic values are never presented as observed facts.

This distinction is a key interview talking point: **do not fabricate missing operational data just to obtain a prettier dashboard.** Instead, document the gap and use synthetic data only for demonstrating the proposed analytical solution.

9. Sources

SRC001 - India Code - 2024-06-21

Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 - enforcement
https://www.indiacode.nic.in/indiacode/handle/123456789/20100?col=123456789%2F1362&view;_type=search

SRC002 - National Testing Agency - 2026-05-02

NTA Fully Prepared for Smooth and Secure Conduct of NEET (UG) 2026
https://www.nta.ac.in/Download/Notice/Notice_20260502215114.pdf

SRC003 - National Testing Agency - 2026-05-10

NTA statement on alleged NEET (UG) 2026 irregularities

<https://cdnbbsr.s3waas.gov.in/s37bc1ec1d9c3426357e69acd5bf320061/uploads/2026/05/20260510635720867.pdf>

SRC004 - Press Information Bureau - 2026-05-12

CBI Registers Case in alleged Paper Leak in NEET-UG 2026

[https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2260410\(=2@=48](https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2260410(=2@=48)

SRC005 - Press Information Bureau - 2026-05-14

CBI arrests two more accused in NEET-UG 2026 paper leak case

[https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2261190\(=2@=48](https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2261190(=2@=48)

SRC006 - Press Information Bureau - 2026-05-15

CBI arrests kingpin in NEET-UG 2026 paper leak case

[https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2261565\(=2@=48](https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2261565(=2@=48)

SRC007 - Press Information Bureau - 2026-05-16

CBI arrests another accused connected with Biology questions

[https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2261767\(=2@=48](https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2261767(=2@=48)

SRC008 - Press Information Bureau - 2026-05-18

CBI arrests coaching institute owner in NEET-UG 2026 paper leak case

[https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2262358\(=2@=48](https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2262358(=2@=48)

SRC009 - Press Information Bureau - 2026-05-27

CBI arrests two more persons in NEET-UG 2026 paper leak case

[https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2265721\(=2@=3](https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2265721(=2@=3)

SRC010 - The Indian Express - 2025-07-24

SSC Selection Post Phase 13 exam disruptions

<https://indianexpress.com/article/education/ssc-selection-post-phase-13-exam-no-data-available-on-candidates-affected-by-centre-changes-tech-failures-10888490/lite/>

SRC011 - The Indian Express - 2026-09-22

SSC says no data on candidates affected by centre changes and tech failures

<https://indianexpress.com/article/education/ssc-selection-post-phase-13-exam-no-data-available-on-candidates-affected-by-centre-changes-tech-failures-10888490/lite/>

SRC012 - Press Information Bureau - 2026-07-30

Rajya Sabha passes Public Examinations Amendment Bill 2026

[https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2292127\(=1@=48](https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2292127(=1@=48)

SRC013 - Press Information Bureau - 2026-07-27

Public Examinations Amendment Bill introduced in Lok Sabha

[https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2290080\(=1@=48](https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2290080(=1@=48)

SRC014 - National Testing Agency - 2026-06-21

NEET-UG 2026 re-examination document trail

<https://neet.nta.nic.in/documents/page/3/>

SRC015 - National Testing Agency - 2025-01-01

NTA tender ecosystem for biometric, CCTV, frisking and security/surveillance

<https://nta.ac.in/Tender>